

TURKEY

L I N U X

High On Steroids

This article deals with getting open source software packages up and running on bare metal/virtual platforms in a stress-free manner.

What happens when your online team asks for a Drupal or Wordpress server, or you require a file server for your branch office really quickly? The answer is that you rush to your Web browser, and start doing Google searches for how-tos, or juggle your ISO collection of distros, spins and remixes. While installing a server, your main concerns are as follows:

- The distro must have a small foot print.
- Packages and related dependencies should be easily installed.
- Configuring Web-management, network and firewall settings should be easy.
- The distro provides up-to-date security patches.

TurnKey Linux is the answer to all your concerns. Whether you are a beginner or an advanced Linux user, you are going to love it.

More about TurnKey Linux

This is a community-oriented open source project conceived by Alon Swartz and Liraz Siri, to simplify our lives. It is available as an installable Live CD ISO and as a virtual machine image format too. If you have cloud access, it won't dishearten you at all. Yes, you got me right—it can be installed on bare metal, on your favourite virtualisation platform (VMware, Parallels, Xen or VirtualBox), or on a

cloud service like Amazon's.

TurnKey Linux, at its core, is a derivative of the Ubuntu 8.04.3 LTS (long-term-support) release, and inherits the same functionality; there's no learning required. It is cautiously built with minimal components needed to serve various roles with efficiency, stability and security. It's also available publicly, for community-involved development.

It is really lightweight, and includes an AJAX Web-shell, Webmin, network, system and tools modules. It only takes four minutes to install on bare metal, and one minute on the virtualisation platform of your choice.

Getting hands-on with TKL

Enough with the feature list; get your hands on TurnKey! Surf to www.turnkeylinux.org and download the ISO image or virtual machine image of your favourite open source software packages. Never mind whether you're a developer or a systems admin, there's an appliance available for you.

Here, I downloaded the file-server appliance virtual machine image from the TKL website using my data card—it's a mere 133 MB in size, and after extraction, it occupied 414 MB on my HDD. The virtual machine image includes *vmdk*, *vmx* and *ovf* files, and can be used with any virtualisation platform.